Flowbit: Infrastructure Cost and Pricing Proposal

Cost per user, margins at today's prices, and recommended prices, including live whiteboard collaboration and the new notification system

Date: October 2026 **Exchange rate:** $1 = ₹96.33 **All prices:** per month, before GST **Profit:** price − Razorpay fee (2%) − infra cost **Margin %:** profit ÷ price

1. Summary

WORK

₹59 → ₹119

Margin 40% → 69%. Most-used product, most underpriced

FOLIO

₹399 → ₹499

Margin 64% → 71% per workspace

SUITE (ALL 4)

₹149 → ₹169

Margin 71% → 74%. +₹9,800/month at 500 users

KEEP AS IS

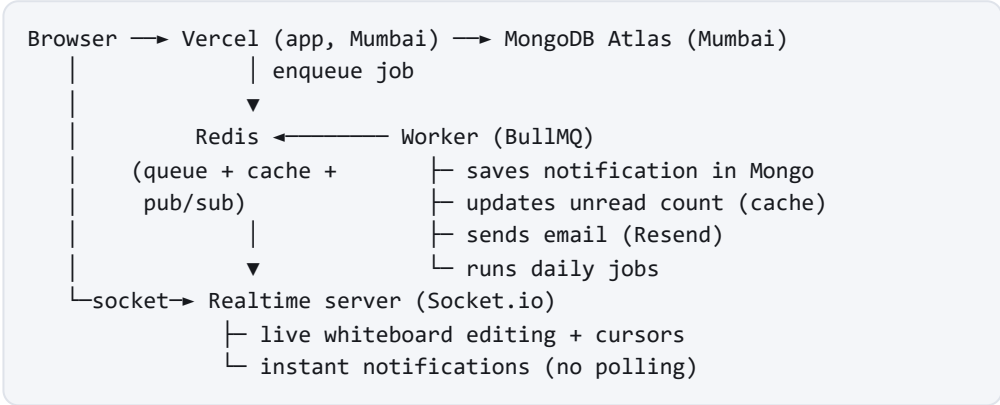
Muster, Orbit

Already at a 75–80% margin

- Most of our cost is **fixed** (about ₹15,300 a month), so cost per user falls quickly as we grow: **₹153 at 100 users, ₹34 at 500, ₹27 at 2,000+**.
- Prices are set for 500+ users. The first ~100 users run near break-even; that is a short, planned investment.
- Break-even is about **93 Suite seats at ₹169**, or **132 Work seats at ₹119**.

2. Platform setup

Service	Role	Region	Status
Vercel Pro	Main app: pages, APIs	Mumbai	Existing
MongoDB Atlas	Database	Mumbai	Existing
Cloudflare R2	File storage (private)	Global	Existing
Resend	Email	n/a	Existing
Realtime server (Socket.io)	Live whiteboard + instant notifications	Render, Singapore	New
Worker (BullMQ)	Notifications, emails, scheduled jobs	Render, Singapore	New
Redis	Job queue, cache, pub/sub	Render, Singapore	New



Socket.io is open source and runs on any host. It's packaged with Docker so it can move to an India host later without code changes, and it scales by adding a Redis adapter.

3. What one user uses per month

Resource	Heavy user (Work, Orbit, Suite: daily, ~8 h)	Light user (Muster self-service: check-in, leave, payslip)
Vercel function calls	~6,000	~1,000
Vercel data transfer	~0.3 GB	~0.05 GB
Live socket connection time	~176 hours	~20 hours
Notification jobs (worker)	~150	~20
Emails	~30	~10
Database growth	~2–3 MB	~0.5 MB
File storage (R2)	~5–10 MB	~1–2 MB

4. Monthly infra cost by number of users

Service	Role	100 users	500 users	2,000 users	5,000 users
Vercel Pro	Main app	$20	$35	$140	$350
MongoDB Atlas	Database	$57 (M10)	$57 (M10)	~$145 (M20)	~$395 (M30)
Cloudflare R2	Files	$0	~$1	~$2	~$4
Resend	Email	$20	$20	$90	~$150
Realtime server (Render)	Whiteboard + live push	$7	$7	$25	$50 (2 servers)
Worker (Render)	Notifications, emails, jobs	$7	$7	$25	$50 (2 workers)
Redis (Render Key Value)	Queue + cache + pub/sub	$10	$10	$10	~$32
Domain, monitoring		$1	$1	$1	~$30
Subtotal		**$122**	**$138**	**$438**	**$1,061**
+30% buffer	Staging, backups, spikes	$159	$179	$569	$1,379
Total in ₹		**₹15,316**	**₹17,243**	**₹54,812**	**₹1,32,839**
Cost per user		**₹153**	**₹34**	**₹27**	**₹27**

Cost per user at 500+ users: heavy user ~₹34, light user ~₹9, Suite user ~₹40, Folio workspace ~₹136. These are the costs used in section 5.

5. Each product: current vs recommended price (per user, at 500 users)

			Current			Recommended			
Product	Unit	Infra cost	Price	Profit	Margin	Price	Change	Profit	Margin
Work	per user	₹34	₹59	₹24	40%	**₹119**	+₹60	₹83	69%
Muster Starter	per employee	₹9	₹39	₹29	75%	**₹39**	no change	₹29	75%
Muster Business	per employee	₹14	₹79	₹63	80%	**₹79**	no change	₹63	80%
Orbit	per sales user	₹34	₹149	₹112	75%	**₹149**	no change	₹112	75%
Folio	per workspace	₹136	₹399	₹255	64%	**₹499**	+₹100	₹353	71%
Suite (all 4)	**per person**	**₹40**	**₹149**	**₹106**	71%	**₹169**	+₹20	**₹126**	74%

Margin colours: 75%+ healthy · 65–74% acceptable · below 65% too low.

6. Complete package (Suite) for the whole business

This uses the total monthly infra bill from section 4, so the margins differ a little from section 5, which uses each product's own usage.

Current: ₹149 per person						Recommended: ₹169 per person					
Users	Revenue	Razorpay 2%	Infra cost	Profit	Margin	Users	Revenue	Razorpay 2%	Infra cost	Profit	Margin
100	₹14,900	₹298	₹15,316	−₹714	−5%	100	₹16,900	₹338	₹15,316	₹1,246	7%
500	₹74,500	₹1,490	₹17,243	₹55,767	75%	500	₹84,500	₹1,690	₹17,243	₹65,567	78%
2,000	₹2,98,000	₹5,960	₹54,812	₹2,37,228	80%	2,000	₹3,38,000	₹6,760	₹54,812	₹2,76,428	82%
5,000	₹7,45,000	₹14,900	₹1,32,839	₹5,97,261	80%	5,000	₹8,45,000	₹16,900	₹1,32,839	₹6,95,261	82%

Extra profit per month from ₹169 instead of ₹149	100 users	500 users	2,000 users	5,000 users
	+₹1,960	**+₹9,800**	**+₹39,200**	**+₹98,000**

7. Break-even (where revenue covers infra cost)

Plan and price	Profit per seat after Razorpay (before infra)	Seats needed to cover ₹15,316/month
Suite at ₹169 (recommended)	₹165.62	**~93 seats**
Suite at ₹149 (current)	₹146.02	~105 seats
Work at ₹119 (recommended)	₹116.62	**~132 seats**
Work at ₹59 (current)	₹57.82	~265 seats

The ₹15,316 includes the 30% buffer. Actual bills at 100 users are about $122 ≈ ₹11,750, which lowers each break-even point by roughly a quarter.

8. Assumptions and what is not included

Assumptions

- Heavy user: about 8 hours a day, 22 days a month, app open all day.
- Light user: Muster self-service (check-in, leave, payslips).
- Notifications are pushed through the realtime server, which replaces today's 30-second polling.
- Service prices are approximate (October 2026). Check each provider's pricing page.
- 30% buffer for a staging environment, backups and usage spikes.
- Razorpay fee of about 2% on every payment.

Not included

- **Arc AI (Claude):** billed per use by Anthropic. Sell it as an add-on or cap monthly use.
- **GST:** added to the customer's bill. GST on foreign service bills (Vercel, Render, Atlas) is paid under reverse charge and can be claimed back as input tax credit.
- Salaries, support, marketing and other operating costs.

These are estimates. Re-check them after the first month in production using the real Vercel, Atlas and Render bills.